Sreesanth for a fine 132. I am then joined by Mark Boucher and we continue to score at four or five runs an over. I pass 150, glancing Harbhajan for four to fine leg, and the runs flow into the evening. Maybe Paul Harris did know something after all.

Bouch eventually falls LBW to Kumble for 21 and, when Morné Morkel is out for one, Paul Harris walks out to the middle. I have reached 184 and am now only 16 runs short of fulfilling his prediction. Five overthrows help me on my way as RP Singh shies at the stumps and misses and the ball races away to the boundary. I work a few more singles and a two, and take my score to 194, as Harbhajan continues his marathon spell.

Don't give it away, I repeat to myself. Don't give it away. Keep concentrating. I take two steps down the wicket to his first delivery of the over, and drive the ball straight, but the fielder at long-off does well and we settle for two. I tuck a single away to square leg off the second ball and Harro nudges an easy one off the third. Hardly pausing for breath, Harbhajan turns, rolls in again and bowls … and, with soft hands, I prod the ball away.

Here he comes again. This time, it's a low full toss. I drive past extra cover and the ball speeds away to the boundary. That's my first double century. I punch the air and hug Paul Harris in the middle and, so many miles away, watching on television back in Bela-Bela, my parents and brothers celebrate as well. These are the important moments when all the sacrifices – all the sacrifices everybody has made over all the years, the infinite number of lifts to practice and the endless games in the back garden – all seem so worthwhile.

I take my score to 217 not out by the time bad light and showers bring an early close to the second day. Graeme declares overnight and our bowlers return to dismiss India for a second time, winning the match by an innings and 90 runs inside three days, taking a 1–0 lead in the series. This Test feels like a turning point in my career. For me, the